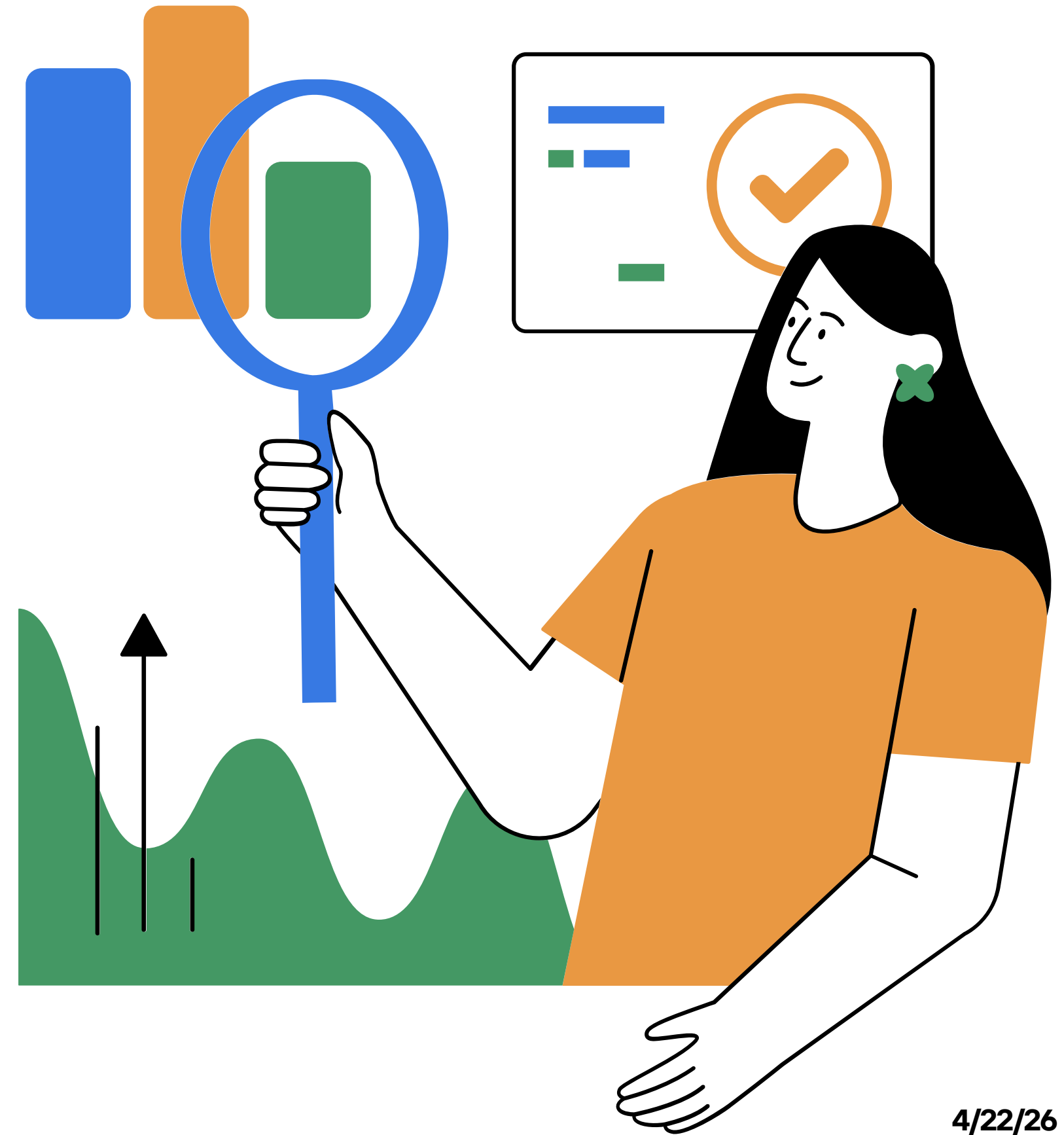


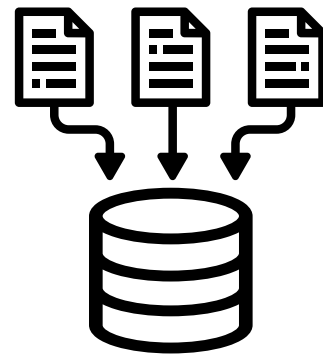
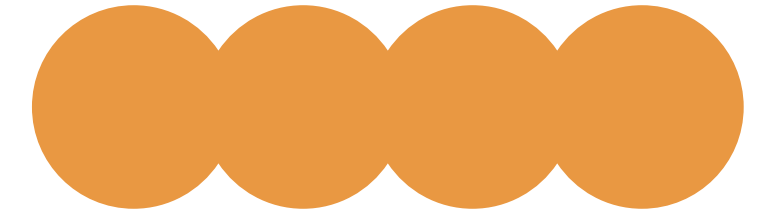
Flaky Results: A GBBO Data Analysis

Chad Willcox and Mike Schottland



4/22/26

The Great Oven-view



**GBBO Dataset - Bakers, Episodes, Challenge Bakes,
Outcomes, Seasons**



**What led to success? What traits did the bakers have? How
are we going to clean this data?**

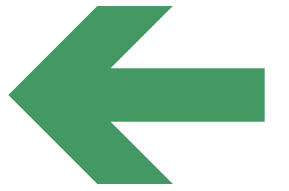


**Two people working on messy data without any experience
baking or even watching baking shows**

Problem # 1:

Change the name

leave the flavor



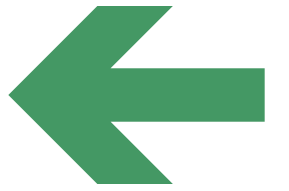
	safe
▶	0
	1
	FALSE
	no
	Y
	yes
	TRUE
	N

```
UPDATE outcomes_edits
SET safe_edits =
CASE
    WHEN LOWER(TRIM(safe)) IN ('0', 'false', 'no', 'n') THEN 0
    WHEN LOWER(TRIM(safe)) IN ('1', 'true', 'yes', 'y') THEN 1
    ELSE NULL
END;
```

A problem in several columns from outcomes (star_baker, eliminated, did_well, safe, at_risk, and handshake) all had was that there were several "names" for the same thing. There is (we assumed) no difference between a "1" and "Y", so we used a case when on the lower version of each row for all of these to make them easier to compare.

Problem # 2:

All CAPS, no crumbs



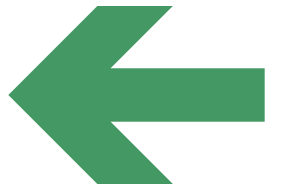
baker
Hermine
amanda
Maggie

```
-- update bakers to first initial capital then all lower to match the rest --  
update challenge_bakes_edits  
set baker_edits =  
trim(concat(upper(left(baker,1)), lower(substring(baker,2))))  
;
```

A problem in challenge_bakes' baker column was that there were random capitalization and non-capitalization throughout. We decided to standardize all our baker columns and have the first letter be capital with the rest lower-case. We also inserted a trim statement to catch any potential blank spaces we missed.

Problem # 3:

Seasoned to perfection



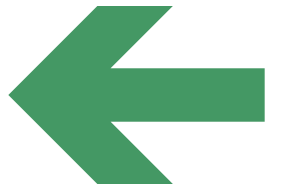
season
1
2
Season 2

```
create table bakers_edits as
select trim(regex_replace(season, '[A-Za-z]', '')) as season,
baker, age, gender, notes from bakers_raw
```

A problem in the bakers table was that many seasons had the word "Season" in them and thus were impossible to compare. We used regex to replace all letters with blanks, leaving just the integer for a season so we could compare more easily.

Problem # 4:

Top-rated tastes



my_rating
7.3/10
6.8
7.3

```
-- remove /10 from my_rating --
```

```
update episodes_edits
```

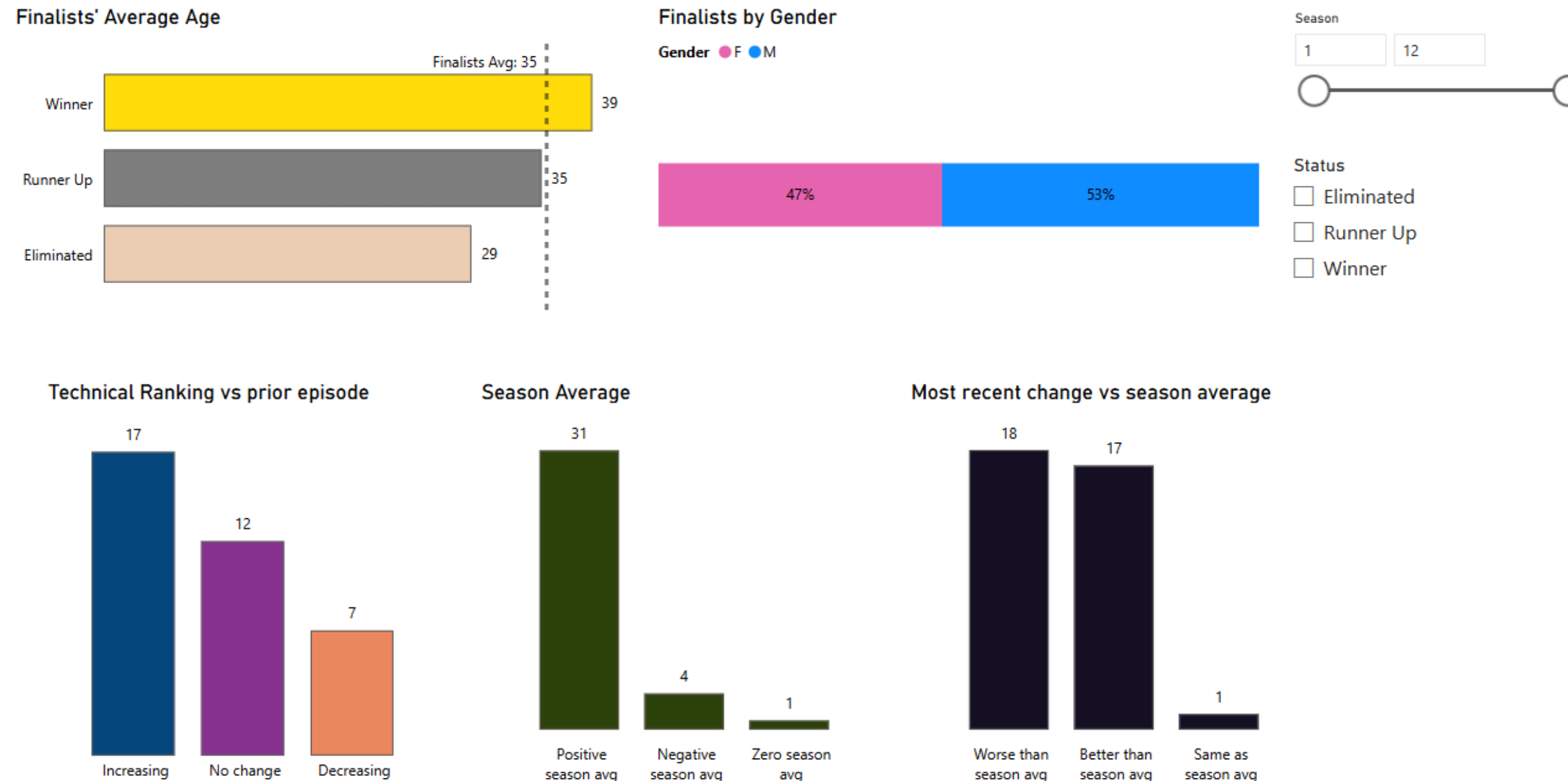
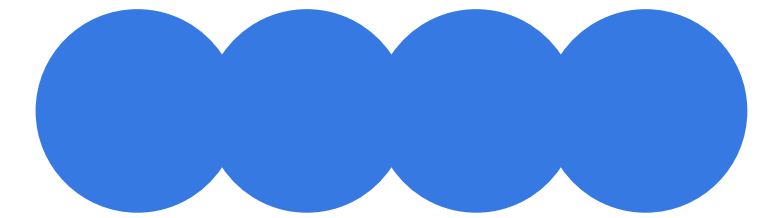
```
set my_rating_edit = replace(my_rating, "/10", "")
```

```
where 1=1
```

```
;
```

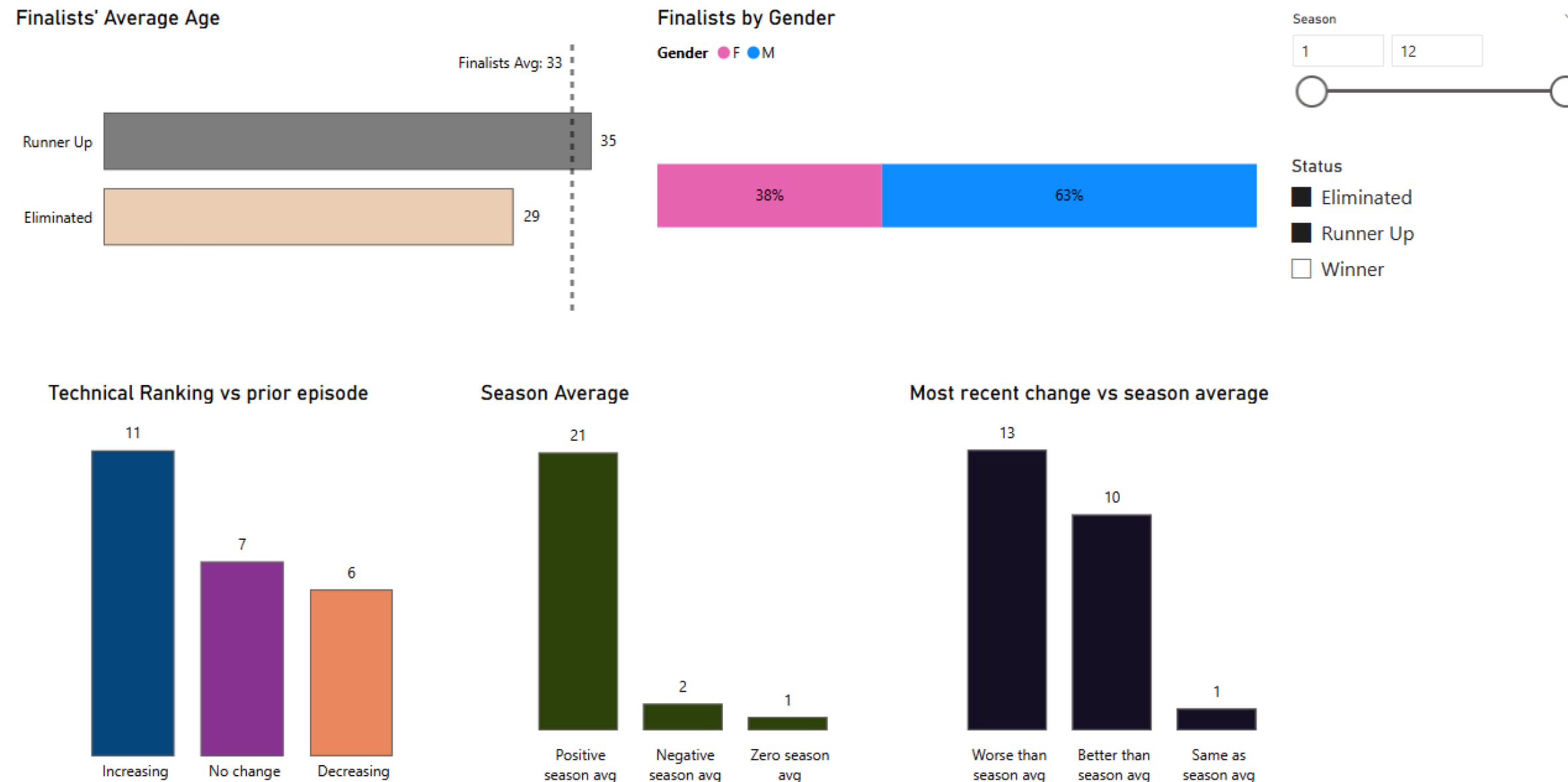
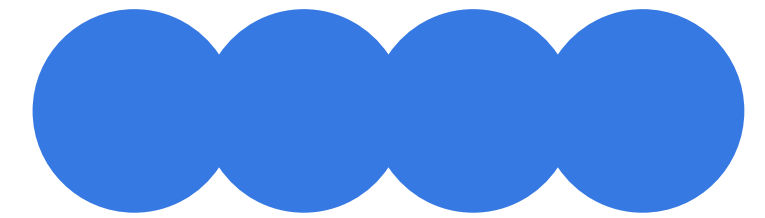
A problem in the episodes table was the my_rating column having some ratings show /10 and others didn't have it. We just used a replace function to replace all "/10" with blanks. This left a decimal we could work with and aggregate (avg, median, etc.) and we could reference the fact that they were out of 10 later on.

Finalists: Keep dough-ing better!



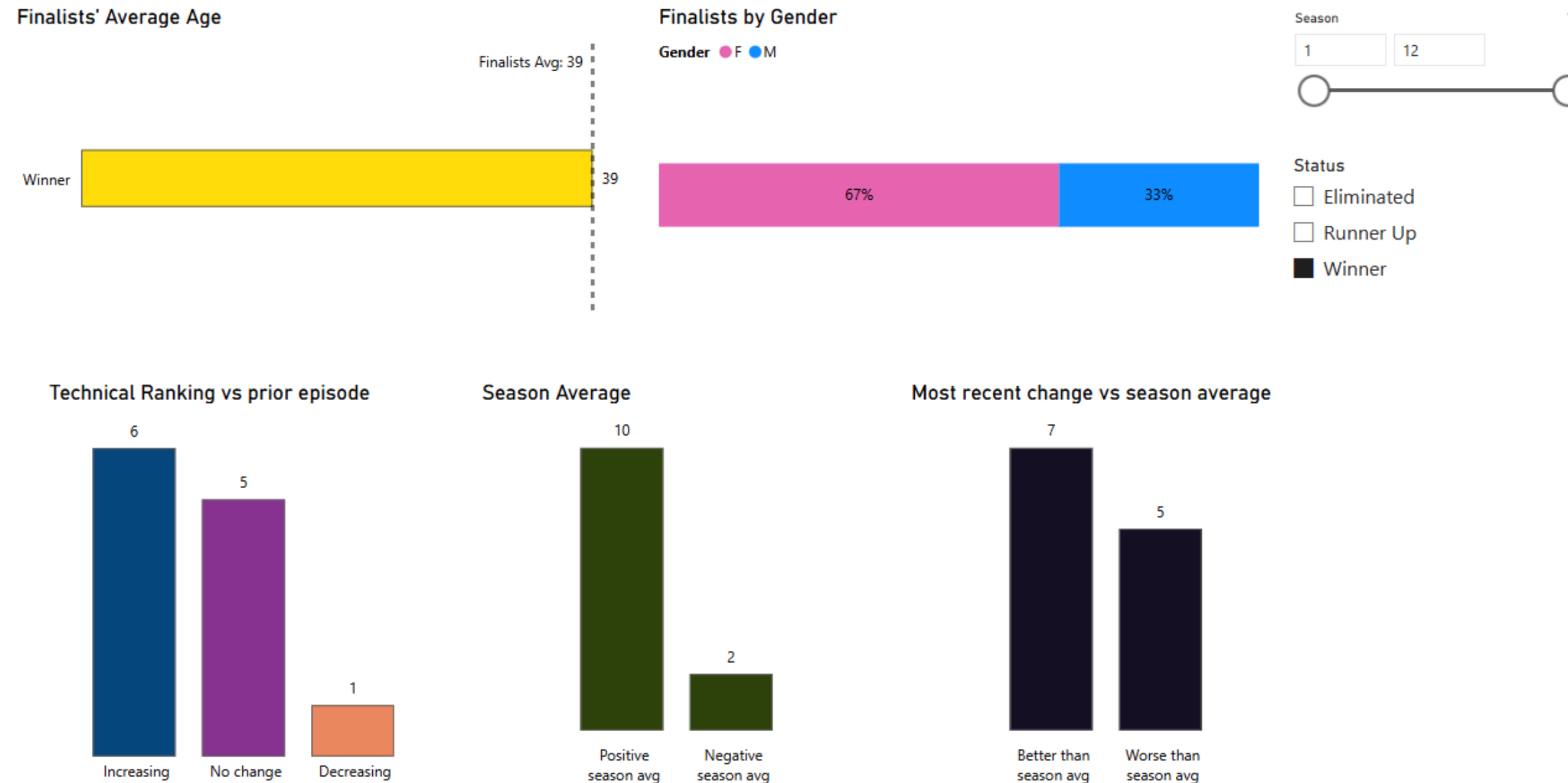
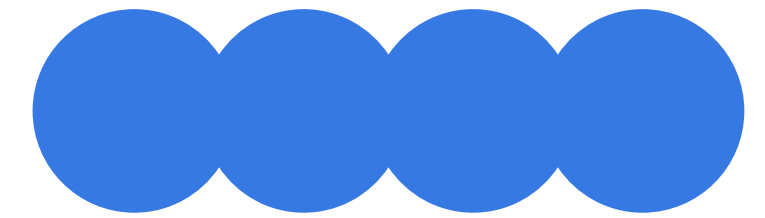
Finalists were most likely to be increasing in technical rank over the prior episode, have a positive season average, and underperform their season average in the final episode.

Losing in the final: A Half-Baked Exit



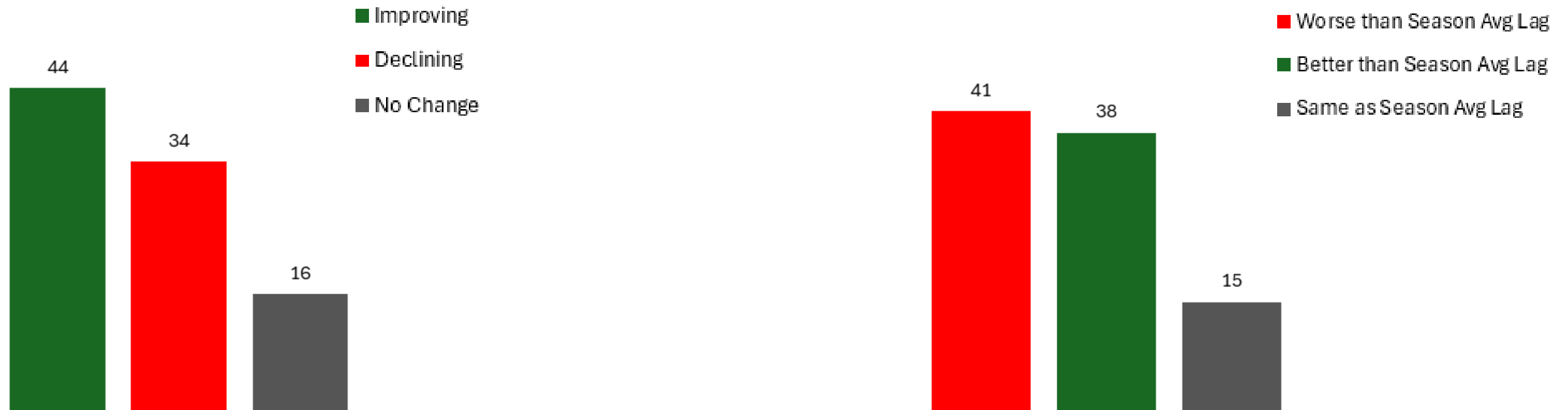
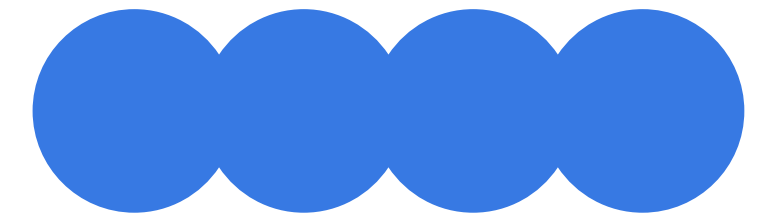
Those that lost in the finals were likely to be increasing over the prior episode, have a positive season average, but perform worse than their season average in the final episode.

Winners: Always in Season



Winners were more likely to be increasing over their prior episode ranking, have a positive season average, and actually outperform that season average in the final competition. Notably, $\frac{2}{3}$ winners were female despite making up less than $\frac{1}{2}$ of all finalists.

Eliminated: No Longer in the mix

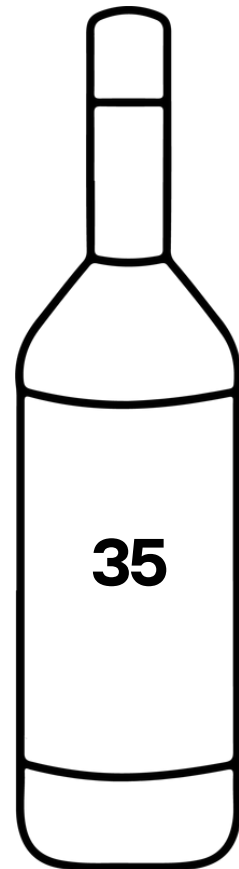


Of the eliminated bakers, the largest categories were improving over the prior episode but performing worse than their season average lagged variable. We excluded episode 1 of each season to be able to use our lagged variable.

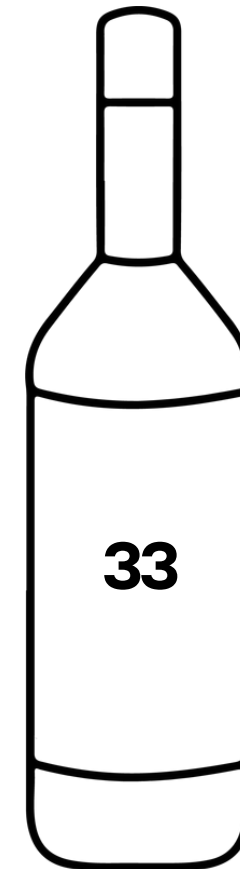
(Average) Aged like a Fine Wine



Average Age of Non-Finalists



Average Age of Finalists



Average Age of Non-Winner Finalists



Average Age of Winners

The Average Age of Winners was larger than any other category.

(Median) Aged like a Fine Wine



Median Age of Non-Finalists



Median Age of Finalists



Median Age of Non-Winner Finalists

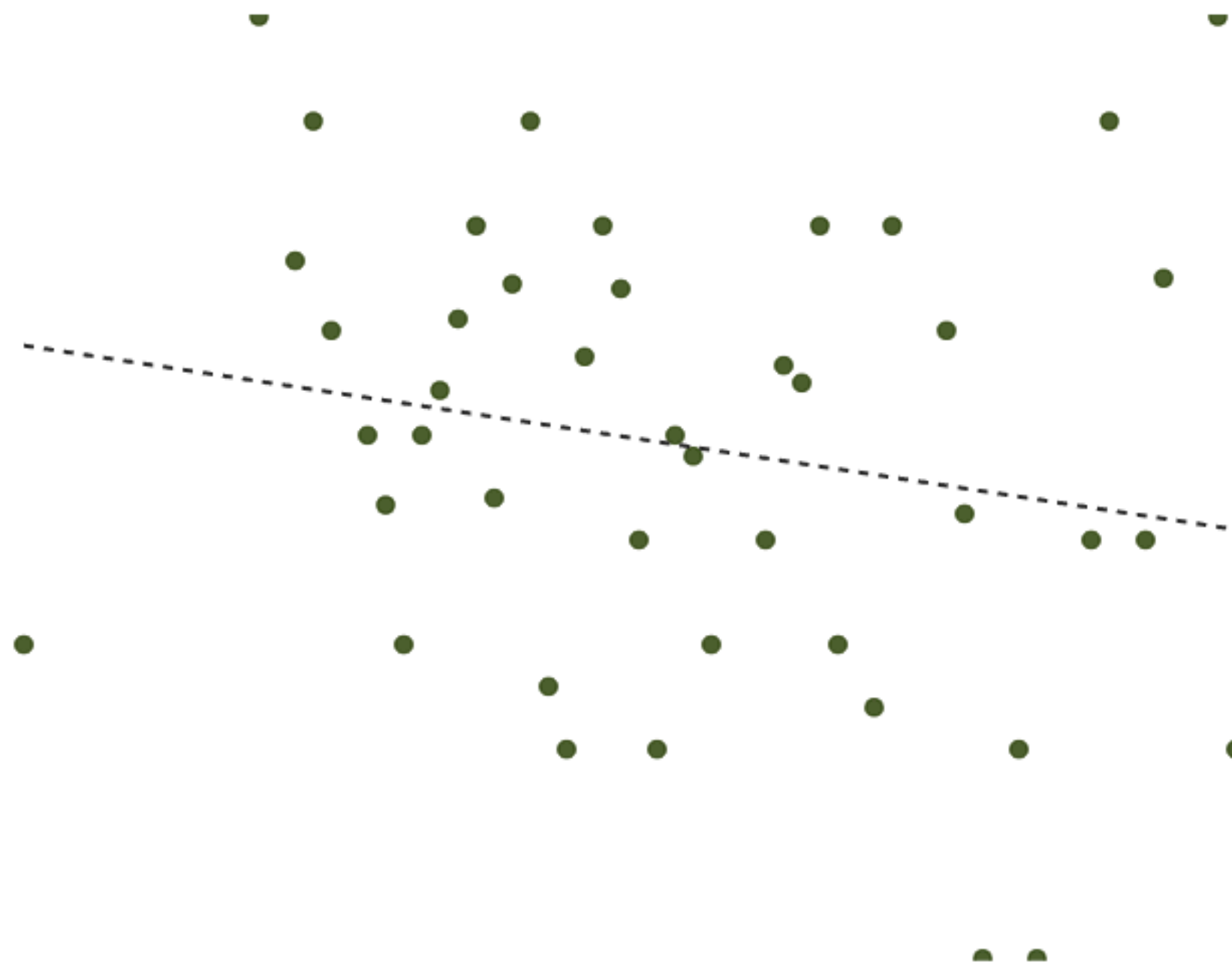


Median Age of Winners

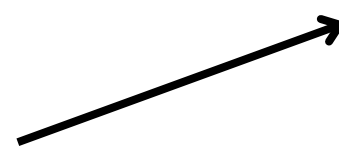
The Median Age of Winners was larger than any other category.

Good taste has a shelf-life

Average Episodes Stayed (Y) vs Age (X)



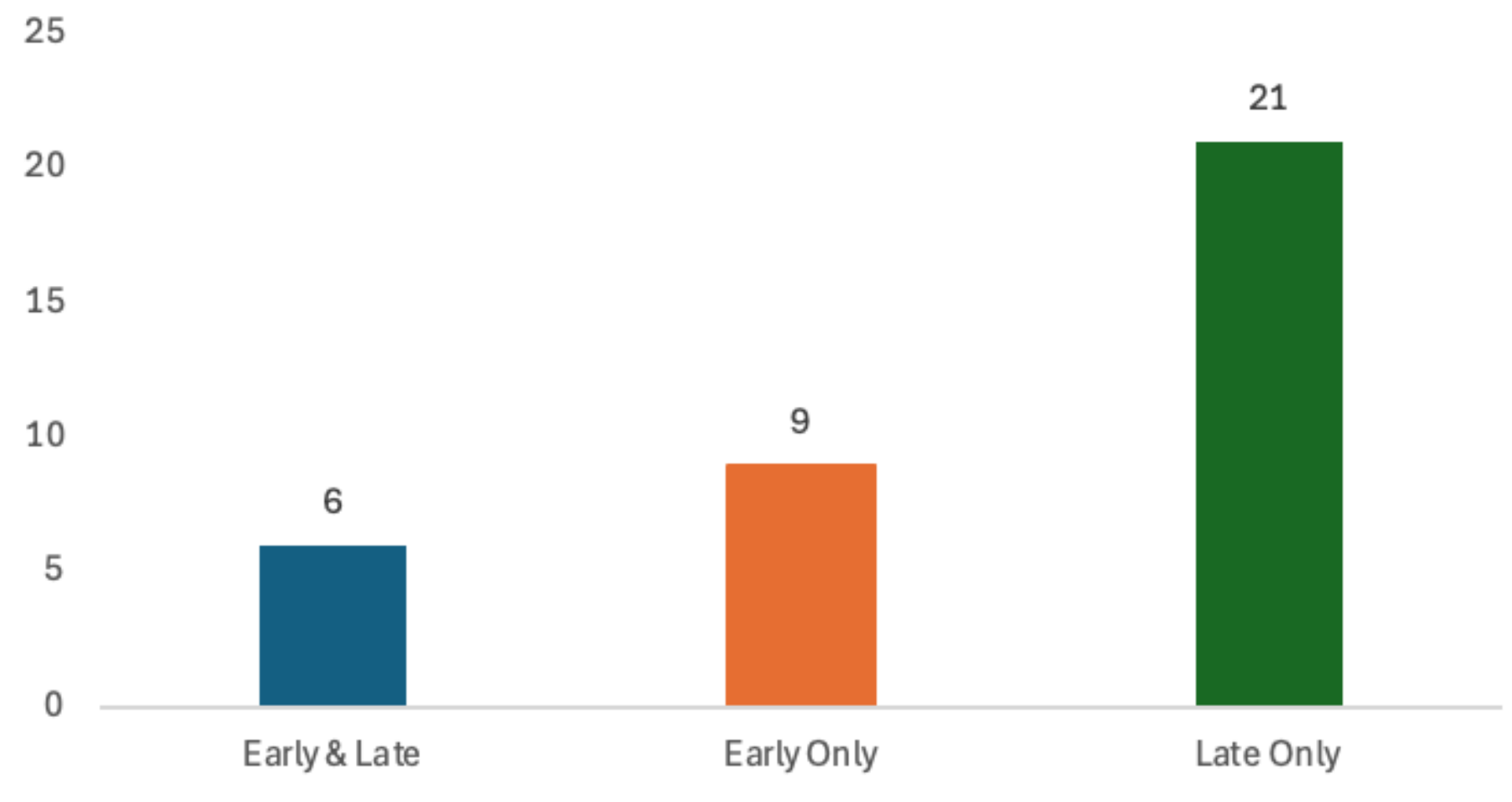
This is 4 year old
Tim. We know.



Interestingly, Age had a negative correlation with average episodes a baker stayed on the show which we use to represent longevity or tenure.

A crust above the rest

Star Bakers Reaching the Finals



If a baker earned the Star Baker Prize only in later part of the season, they had a 75% chance of making the finals.

If a baker earned a Star Baker Prize during the early and late portion of a season, they had a 55% chance of making the finals.

If a baker earned the Star Baker Prize only in the early part of the season, they had a 36%% chance of making the finals.

Ruth from Season 1 was the only overall winner that was never awarded the Star Baker prize.

Formulas and Definitions:

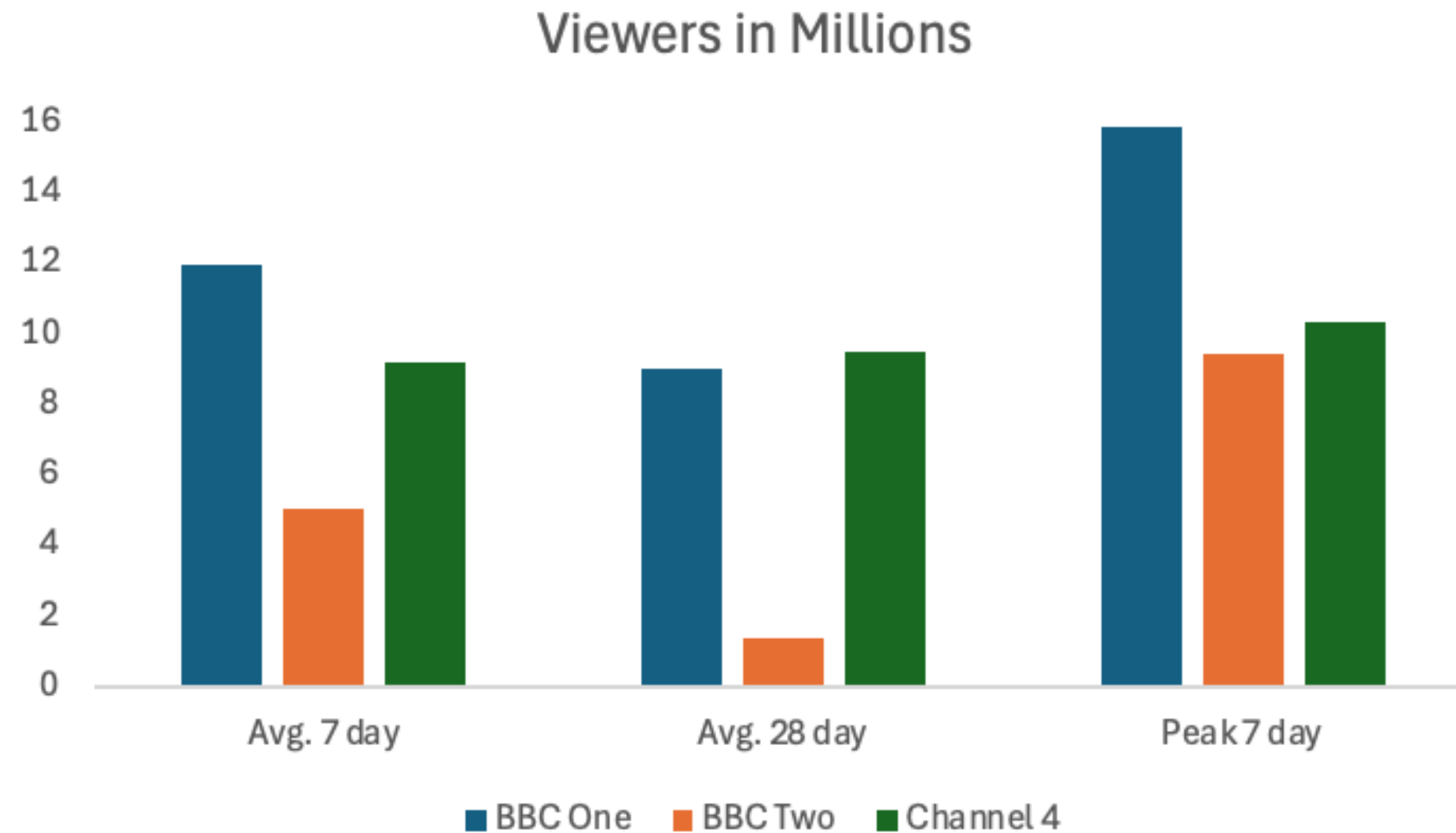
Weighted Score = Episode Baker earned prize / Total Episodes that Season

Early versus Late season = Episode number / Total Episodes that Season

Early Season ≤ 0.5

Finals is defined as making it to the last episode of the season.

Loaf-ty Standards



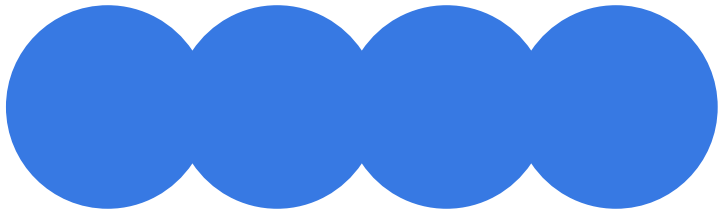
Using a more detailed data set from GitHub, we compared viewership numbers across BBC One, BBC Two, and Channel 4.

Though the BBC One series were the most viewed, Channel 4 was comparable, and had the most catch up viewing.

External data source (Github):

https://github.com/apreshill/bakeoff/blob/main/data-raw/cleaned-files/ratings_seasons.csv

Surprise



Entry #	24
Table / Column	Seasons / location
What we found	Some left out country and some had it
Options considered	Leave out country for all, add it to those that don't have it
Decision & rationale	Having country would be good so I just added it to those that didn't have it
Risk / limitation	Some may not be in the UK but I assumed this wasn't the case

Some of the locations left out country, but we assumed they were all in the UK. We did not have time to double check this assumption, so moving forward we would do so and make sure there weren't any special seasons or visits to somewhere outside the country.



Thank You

